

one Act Play
Luke, Brooklyn, Dante
Hudson, Charlie

Joseph's Story

By Annette Wetherbee

Summary

A "quick-change" version of the story of Joseph, designed for only five people.

Characters

Luke - Narrator

Hudson - Joseph

Brooklyn - Jacob, slave trader, cup bearer

Dante - brother, Potiphar, baker

Charlie - brother, Pharaoh

Scene

Blank stage with a backdrop for players to run behind during "quick changes". Stool on far side where narrator sits. All players are dressed in black and change characters by the props they are using. Quick paced and energetic.

Props

beard, staff for Jacob, coat of many colours, vests for brothers, clip board, cup, baker's hat or loaf of bread, Pharaoh's crown,

Script

Narrator: This is a story about Joseph.

Joe: Hi.

Narrator: Not yet.

Joe: Oh.

Narrator: Long ago, in a faraway land lived a man named Jacob. (Out comes Brooklyn in beard.)

Joe: I thought this was about me?

Narrator: It is - just wait! Jacob had 12 sons, one by the name of Joseph...

Joe: Me!

Narrator: ...who by the way, was his favourite.

Joe: I'm the favourite.

Narrator: Which didn't sit well with the other brothers (Brooklyn, Dante & Charlie appear looking disgruntled) especially when Jacob gave Joseph a special coat- (Brooklyn gives Joseph coat)

Joe: OOOOO... a coat of many colours

Dante: Isn't that special.

Narrator: On top of all that, Joseph was a dreamer. He had two dreams which didn't go over well with his already jealous brothers.

Joe: Listen to this dream I had, we were binding sheaves of grain out in the field when suddenly my sheaf rose and stood upright, while your sheaves gathered around mine and bowed down to it.

Brooklyn: Do you intend to reign over us?

Dante: Will you actually rule us?

Narrator: And they hated him all the more because of his dream and what he had said.

Joe: Listen, I had another dream, and this time the sun and moon and eleven stars were bowing down to me.

Narrator: When he told his father as well as his brothers, his father rebuked him

Brooklyn (as Jacob): What is this dream you had? Will your I, your mother, and your brothers actually come and bow down to the ground before you?

Charlie: Like I'll ever bow to him!?

Dante: Yea me too, (to Charlie) I would much rather bow to you than Joseph

Narrator: His brothers were jealous of him, but his father kept the matter in mind.

Narrator: One day Jacob sent Joseph out to check up on his brothers who were out watching the sheep.

Charlie: Why do we get stuck with the sheep?

Dante: Because he's the favourite.

Charlie: Oh, yeah. I forgot.

Dante: Look here comes the dreamer.

Brooklyn: Lets kill him

Charlie: But how will we do it

Brooklyn: We can throw him in the well and say some ferocious animal ate him.

Narrator: So they threw him in a well. (Dante & Charlie grab Joseph and throw him behind curtain/wall.)

Joe: AAAAAHHHHH! Come on guys what did I ever do to you.

Brooklyn: You know what you did, ya dreamer.

Dante: Wait - we could make some money out of this!

Charlie: How?

Dante: We could sell him to the Ishmaelite traders as a slave.

Charlie: Good idea!

Narrator: And so, they did. (Take Joseph) and throw him behind the curtain.

Narrator: They brought back the coat torn and covered with animal blood and gave it to their father (Brooklyn returns in beard). Jacob believed his son to be dead and mourned for him.

Brooklyn: My son!!! (Leaves weeping, Brooklyn, Dante & Charlie follow.)

Narrator: Now Joseph was sold to Potiphar, an officer to Pharaoh

Narrator: Potiphar saw that the Lord was with Joseph, and whatever he did prospered, so he put him in charge of all of his household. (Take off rope and give Joseph clip board, then exit) Now, Potiphar's wife took a fancy to Joseph and wanted him to sin against God. She falsely accused Joseph of wrongdoing, so Potiphar had Joseph sent to Pharaoh's prison.

Joe: But I'm innocent.

Charlie (as Potiphar): That's what they all say!

Narrator: Joseph was in Pharaoh's dungeon, but the Lord was with Joseph, and the chief jailer put him in charge, because whatever Joseph did was done well. While in prison, Joseph meets Pharaoh's cupbearer and baker. (Brooklyn & Dante both yell as they pretend to be "thrown" into prison.) They each had a dream, which Joseph told them what they meant.

Joe: I have some good news and some bad news.... (Pretends to tell bad news to baker (Dante), who begins to cry and wander off, and then tells the cup bearer (Brooklyn), who becomes very happy.) Remember me when you get out.

Brooklyn: I will.

Narrator: He didn't. But then several years later, Pharaoh (Charlie comes out as Pharaoh with Brooklyn as cup bearer following) had a dream, and the cup bearer remembered Joseph.

Brooklyn: Hello

Joe: Took you long enough

Narrator: So, Joseph was brought out of prison to tell Pharaoh the meaning of his dreams.

Joe: I have some good news and some bad news...

Narrator: Joseph explained that Pharaoh's dreams meant there would be 7 years of plenty.

Brooklyn & Dante: Yeah!

Narrator: Followed by 7 years of famine.

Brooklyn & Dante: Boo!

Charlie (as Pharaoh): What can I do about it then.

Joe: Store up lots of food during the next 7 years so there will be plenty of food later.

Narrator: Pharaoh put Joseph in charge of preparing for the famine, and when it did come, there was food in Egypt. Thanks to Joseph's supervision and God's warning.

Brooklyn: (as Jacob) There's food in Egypt? (To Dante & Charlie) So what are you waiting for? Go buy some!

Narrator: The brothers went to Egypt

Charlie: 3 bags of grain please.

Joe: sure

Narrator: Then they returned home and after a short time found that they run out of food so they went back to Egypt.

Charlie: This isn't going to be fun! He thinks we're spies!

Narrator: This time, Joseph made himself known.

Joe: I am Joseph!

Narrator: Which really shook them up.

Dante, Charlie, and Brooklyn: AAAHHHH! (fall down)

Narrator: What's this his brothers bowing down to him anyway the brothers figured they'd be punished for all that they had done, but Joseph didn't think so.

Joe: What you meant for evil, God meant for good!

Narrator: So, Joseph sent for his father, (Brooklyn as Jacob reunited with Joseph) and all of his household, and brought them into the land of Egypt where he and his family lived out their days in peace. The End.

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Original by Annette Wetherbee